



Sharply tapered blade

► GREAT HELM

Date 1250–1300

Origin Northern Europe

Material Iron

In use from the time of the Third Crusade (1189–92) for about a century, the cylindrical *heaume* or great helm completely enclosed the wearer's face, so became stifling in battle. Narrow visor slits allowed limited vision.



Cross-shaped plate on front



Red cross crusader badge

The Dreux family arms

▲ SWORD POMMEL

Date 1250

Origin France or England

Material Iron, enamel

Enamelled with the Dreux family arms, this pommel probably came from the sword of Peter de Dreux, Duke of Brittany. He fought alongside Louis IX of France at the disastrous Battle of Mansourah in 1250, during the Seventh Crusade.



Flattened diamond-shaped blade in cross-section



▲ “CRUSADER” SWORD

Date 12th century

Origin Western Europe

Weight 1.27kg (2¾lb)

Length 96.5cm (38in)

Swords with broad blades and simple cross-guards and pommels became popular during the Crusades, and were used widely throughout Europe.



Flattened diamond-section blade



► MAIL ARMOUR

Date 1339–65

Origin Austria

Material Iron

This suit of mail, composed of hundreds of linked iron rings, has a short hem, and was probably worn with extra plate protection. The head was protected by a basinet and a mail aventail.



Mail aventail